

New Sun Kings Ready For Texas League

Will Face Dodgers Friday

The newest version of the El Paso Sun Kings, in the fourth metamorphosis in seven years, will be unveiled to Southwestern baseball fans at 7:30 p.m. Friday at Dudley Field, when the Kings take on the Albuquerque Dodgers in the opening game of the 1967 Texas League season.

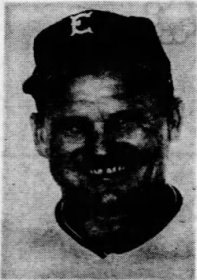
It will be a complete new team, despite a few familiar faces, and may mark as great a change in baseball philosophy as Dudley Field's confines have seen.

Advance indications are that the California Angels, new owners of the ball club, will present a stout pitching staff with a strong accent on defensive baseball, rather than the power hitting and homer-happy squads of previous years.

The Angels purchased the El Paso franchise from the El Paso Sports Association during the past winter and have taken over complete operation of the club and park.

John Stanfill is new general manager of the Sun Kings and Rocky Bridges, a veteran big-league infielder and capable manager, has moved up from San Jose of the California League, following promotion of Chuck Tanner to manage Seattle of the Pacific Coast League.

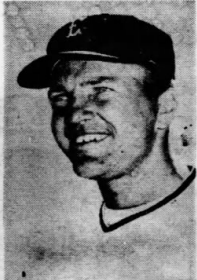
Joining Stanfill and Bridges at the Sun Kings helm are



ROCKY BRIDGES



ANDY COHEN



MOOSE STUBING



JOHN STANFILL

Andy Cohen, veteran baseball player who again will serve as coach for the Kings, and Larry "Moose" Stubing, former first baseman with El Paso and Little Rock, who was signed as player-coach.

An early Angel promise to give El Paso fans the strongest team they can assemble in their farm system appeared born out with assignment of 11 pitchers to Bridges' roster, several of them with Class AAA experience.

Bridges' emphasis on defensive baseball as the answer to the home run output which has marked Dudley Field in the past is one of the changes in baseball philosophy that marks the 1967 Kings.

"The home run is just one run," Bridges has pointed out, "unless you have men on

base. It is going to be our goal to keep those men off the bases as much as possible so that the big hit does a minimum of damage."

In previous years El Paso teams were noted as sluggers and led the league in home runs most seasons. The current Texas League record of 267 homers was established by the 1963 Sun Kings, then a San Francisco Giant chattel.

This year's squad is not powerless. Moose Stubing shared the 1966 home run title with Winston Llenas, El Paso third-sacker now with the Mexican League. Jim Spencer, at first base, belted 16 homers a year ago and outfielder Don Wilkinson hammered 19. Catcher Tom Eagan crashed 11 fourmasters and Ethan Blackaby, acquired from Austin, hits with power.

The Sun Kings came into existence with organization of El Paso Sports Association in 1961, when the club was a member of the Sophomore League with a Giant working agreement.

In 1962 the Kings joined the Texas League, again with a Giant working arrangement and won the championship their first season.

The Giants dropped their working agreement after the

The El Paso Sun Kings set a Texas League record of 267 home runs during the 1963 season. During that season they hit six homers in one game, twice hit five in a game, and four times hit four in one game. Opponents hit 123 homers during that season against them.

International Flavor Set In Opening

Opening ceremonies for the 1967 Texas League season at Dudley Field Friday night will have an international flavor, with dignitaries from both Juarez and El Paso taking part in the traditional affair.

Ceremonies to open the new season begin at 7:30 p.m. with the El Paso Sun Kings facing the Albuquerque Dodgers at approximately 8 p.m.

Juarez Mayor Armando Soto is scheduled to throw out the first ball of the season with El Paso Mayor Judson Williams to be on the receiving end.

Prior to the symbolic opening members of the Sun King and the Dodgers rosters are to be introduced by El Paso manager Rocky Bridges and Albuquerque skipper Duke Snider.

John Phelan, president of El Paso Sports Association, which operated the El Paso club before the Angels purchased the franchise last winter, is to act as master of ceremonies.

Music in a pre-game concert will be provided by the Thunderbird band of Coronado High School, which also will play the national anthems of United States and Mexico as part of the opening.

Special guest at the opening will be Hugh Finerty, president of the Texas League.

The Cover

The new look of the El Paso Sun Kings, who this year are fullfledged members of the California Angels under Angel ownership, is reflected by this trio of new faces at the helm of the club. Snapped during a hall in spring training workouts at the Angel farm base at Holtville, Calif., left to right, are John Stanfill, new general manager of the club, Larry "Moose" Stubing, new player-coach, and Everett Lamar "Rocky" Bridges, new field manager.

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